

Island Tours · Booking Confirmation Email (spec + locked EN content)

Status: locked for build. Open items tracked in section 9. Currency examples shown as USD and EUR. No em-dashes. Built by Islanders voice.

This is the single transactional email that fires the moment a booking is made. One dynamic template serves every booking, tour, and language, and branches on `paymentModel` across four payment models (see section 5). It is the first email in the post-booking sequence and carries the anti-phishing mitigation (C2): block 6 adapts to the payment model and foreshadows the operator's separate payment or confirmation email, so that email is expected, not treated as spam.

1. Purpose and scope

Jobs of this email, in priority order:

1. Confirm the booking succeeded, with the reference, fast and unmistakably.
2. Show what was booked (tour, date, time, meeting point or pickup, party, amounts).
3. Set the payment expectation for the booking's payment model (what was paid, what is left, who collects it).
4. Protect against fraud and against a missed payment email landing in spam.
5. Give a clear cancel path and a way to reach support.

In scope: the Island Tours confirmation email (one dynamic template, 7 languages, four payment models).

Out of scope: the operator payment email (operator-sent, not Island Tours branded), the 48h pre-tour reminder, and the cancellation confirmation. Those are separate artifacts in the same sequence; their copy is locked in `Design_Brief_BookingWidget.md §6.2` and referenced here for consistency.

2. Sequence context (do not design in isolation)

1. Booking confirmation (THIS email, Island Tours, at booking).
2. Operator email, payment link or confirmation, where the payment model includes one (operator-sent; references §6.2 where it is a balance reminder).
3. Pre-tour reminder, 48h before (meeting point, what to bring, weather note).
4. Cancellation confirmation (only if cancelled, carries the refund split and timing).

This email foreshadows #2 and links to the cancel path that produces #4. It does not repeat the refund split or refund timing; those live in #4 only.

3. Subject line and preheader

Subject: (You're booked: {tourName} on {dateShort}) Subject ((paymentModel = operator_full)): (Reservation sent: {tourName} on {dateShort}) Preheader: (Your spot is reserved. Here are your details and what happens next.)

No emoji, no scarcity or salesy words.

4. Content blocks (in order)

1. Confirmation line plus booking reference. Top, direct, no preamble.
 2. Booking summary: tour featured image (square thumbnail) beside tour title, operator, date and start time. "View tour details" and "Add to calendar" links.
 3. Core details, scannable rows (all conditional): meeting point or pickup, arrival buffer, end point if different, party, tour language, duration, special requests.
 4. Note from the operator (conditional, operator-authored).
 5. Payment summary: amounts plus the one computed deadline. Branches on (paymentModel).
 6. How to pay (C2 foreshadow, mandatory). Branches on (paymentModel). Anti-fraud note sits directly below, shield icon, neutral gray.
 7. Prepare: What to bring and Good to know (both conditional).
 8. Questions, split: day-of and activity to the operator (raw phone and email); booking to Island Tours WhatsApp.
 9. Cancel path: deadline, tokenized cancel button (opens a request form, not an instant cancel), account pointer. Branches on (paymentModel). Placed low, away from the payment framing.
 10. Built by Islanders sign-off and sender identity.
 11. More {islandName} experiences (upsell). Bottom-anchored, two cards, no social row. Never above block 6.
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5. Merge variables and conditional blocks

Merge variables (per booking, from Supabase)

Variable	Example	Notes
(firstName)	Denley	Greeting only
(tourName)	Klein Curaçao Day Trip	

Variable	Example	Notes
<code>operatorName</code>	Miss Ann Boat Trips	Shown in block 1 and block 5
<code>featuredImageUrl</code>	...	Tour featured image (first gallery photo). Rendered as a square thumbnail, object-fit cover, same asset and crop format as the checkout booking summary. Not a separate header crop. alt = tourName
<code>dateLong</code>	Friday, 22 May 2026	Locale-formatted
<code>dateShort</code>	22 May 2026	Subject line
<code>startTime</code>	08:00	24-hour
<code>meetingPoint</code> / <code>pickupLocation</code> / <code>pickupTime</code>	...	Meeting or pickup renders per <code>hasPickup</code> ; <code>pickupTime</code> conditional, locale-formatted
<code>mapUrl</code>	...	Maps deep link for the location
<code>partyBreakdown</code>	2 adults, 1 child	Locale pluralized
<code>duration</code>	9 hours	Conditional
<code>depositAmount</code>	\$40.00 / €37,00	Locale currency
<code>balanceAmount</code>	\$160.00 / €148,00	Locale currency
<code>totalAmount</code>	\$200.00 / €185,00	Locale currency
<code>depositPct</code>	20	Dynamic 20 to 30
<code>paymentModel</code>	operator_link	<code>operator_link</code> (deposit to IT, operator emails balance link), <code>on_arrival</code> (deposit to IT, balance paid in person on arrival), <code>paid_in_full</code> (100% to IT, operator also sends its own confirmation), or <code>operator_full</code> (0% to IT, operator emails a full-payment link and confirms the spot; operator settles commission with IT afterward). Branches blocks 1, 5, 6, 9

Variable	Example	Notes
<code>onArrivalPayment</code>	card_or_cash	Only when <code>paymentModel = on_arrival</code> . <code>card_or_cash</code> (card and cash accepted) or <code>cash_only</code> (cash, no card, no ATM on site). Per operator
<code>cancelHours</code>	48	24, 48, 72, or 168; default 48. Per tour. The single window for both balance payment and free cancellation
<code>cancelDeadlineDateTime</code>	Wed, 20 May 2026, 08:00	Computed: tour start minus <code>cancelHours</code> , tour local time, 24-hour. Used for both "pay your balance" and "cancel for a full refund"
<code>bookingRef</code>	IT-2026-04821	
<code>tourUrl</code>	...	View tour details, back to the tour page
<code>calendarUrl</code>	...	Add to calendar (.ics or calendar link); event at {pickupTime} if pickup, else {startTime}, with tour title and location
<code>arrivalBufferMin</code>	5 (pickup) / 30 (meeting)	Default depends on <code>hasPickup</code> ; overridable per tour
<code>tourLanguage</code>	English	Conditional. Language the tour is conducted in
<code>endPoint</code>	...	Conditional. Only renders if different from the start or meeting point
<code>operatorNote</code>	Seas can be rough on the way out, mainly in some seasons.	Conditional, operator-supplied per tour
<code>knowBeforeYouGo[]</code>	...	Conditional list, kept short
<code>operatorPhone</code> / <code>operatorEmail</code>	+599 9 560 1367 / info@...	Day-of operator contact, shown raw at launch (decided). Rendered as tel: and mailto: links
<code>relatedTours[]</code>	2 items	Upsell: featured image (landscape card crop), title, rating, price, url. Bottom-anchored

Variable	Example	Notes
<code>islandName</code>	Curaçao	Island of the booked tour. Drives the upsell title and CTA. Aruba and Sint Maarten at expansion
<code>allToursUrl</code>	...	Catalog for <code>islandName</code> (e.g. the Curaçao tours listing)
<code>cancelUrl</code>	tokenized	Opens the cancellation request form on island.tours, never a raw cancel
<code>accountUrl</code>	island.tours/bookings	The traveler's account (auto-created at booking): booking, invoice, history
<code>whatsappUrl</code>	...	Prefilled WhatsApp, for booking and refund questions
<code>whatToBring[]</code>	...	Conditional list
<code>specialRequests</code>	...	Conditional
<code>locale</code>	en, nl, de, fr, es, pt, zh	Drives copy, date, currency

Build note on names: use a first-name field only; guard the merge so name prefixes (e.g. Dutch "van") and missing names degrade gracefully.

Conditional blocks (same template, different render)

- Pickup vs meet-at-point (`hasPickup`).
- Arrival buffer present or absent.
- Tour language present or absent.
- End point present only when different from start.
- Operator note present or absent.
- Good to know (`knowBeforeYouGo`) present or absent.
- Duration present or absent.
- What to bring present or absent.
- Special requests present or absent (renders "Your note to the operator").
- Cancellation window value resolves `cancelHours` (24, 48, 72, 168) and the computed deadline dates.

6. i18n and currency

- 7 languages, EN primary. i18n resource files, one key per copy string. Avoid idioms so

strings translate cleanly.

- Locale-aware date and currency formatting. Date follows the locale (Friday, 22 May 2026 in EN, vrijdag 22 mei 2026 in NL). Currency follows the locale mapping below, with locale number formatting (\$1,234.56 vs €1.234,56).
 - Currency by locale (Section4_7 line 730): USD for EN and ZH, EUR for NL, DE, FR, ES, PT. Fixed per locale at launch, no user selector.
 - One deadline governs both balance payment and free cancellation, dynamic per tour (`cancelHours`), shown as an absolute computed timestamp, not relative hours. The traveler can pay the balance, or cancel for a full refund, up to that moment. It is tour start minus `cancelHours`, expressed in the tour's local time (Curaçao is AST, UTC-4, no daylight saving) and locale-formatted. No separate 72h reminder date is shown in the email.
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7. Provider and deliverability

- Primary provider: Resend, template built in React Email (same language as the app, conditionals plus i18n, easy for Arnav to maintain).
 - Fallback: Postmark, only if deliverability becomes the bottleneck at scale.
 - Non-negotiable: full SPF, DKIM, and DMARC on a dedicated transactional subdomain (for example `bookings@mail.island.tours`), separate from the marketing stream. Marketing reputation must never touch transactional deliverability. This is the real lever on the C2 mitigation, more than the provider's baseline.
 - Send within minutes of booking. Transactional only, so no marketing unsubscribe block, but include sender identity and a physical or business address in the footer.
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8. Locked EN content

Ready for i18n. Em-dash free. Variables in `{braces}`. Conditional sections marked `[IF ...]`. Currency shown as USD with the EUR equivalent in brackets for the i18n team.

Subject and preheader

Subject: You're booked: {tourName} on {dateShort}

Preheader: Your spot is reserved. Here are your details and what happens next.

Block 1 • Confirmation

[IF paymentModel = operator_full] ## Reservation sent, {firstName}.

[ELSE] ## You're booked, {firstName}. [/IF]

Booking reference: {bookingRef}

Block 2 • Booking summary header

[tour featured image as a square thumbnail, alt = {tourName}, beside the title below]

{tourName}

{operatorName} {dateLong} · {startTime} [View tour details](#) · [Add to calendar](#)

Block 3 · Your booking

[IF hasPickup] Pickup: {pickupLocation}, {pickupTime}. [Open in Maps](#) [ELSE] Meeting point: {meetingPoint}. [Open in Maps](#) [/IF] Note: if no {pickupTime} is set at booking, drop it so the line reads "Pickup: {pickupLocation}". Use "around {pickupTime}" only if the time is provisional. [IF hasPickup] Please be ready {arrivalBufferMin} minutes before pickup. [default 5] [/IF] [IF NOT hasPickup] Please arrive {arrivalBufferMin} minutes early. [default 30, own transport to the meeting point] [/IF] [IF endPoint] Ends at: {endPoint} [/IF] Guests: {partyBreakdown} [IF tourLanguage] Language: {tourLanguage} [/IF] [IF duration] Duration: {duration} [/IF] [IF specialRequests] Your note to the operator: {specialRequests} [/IF]

Note: date and start time live in the block 2 header, not repeated here.

Block 4 · Note from the operator (conditional)

[IF operatorNote] ### A note from {operatorName}
{operatorNote} [/IF]

Data source: `operatorNote` is an optional operator-filled field; the block renders only when present. Do not place generic Island Tours copy here (the heading attributes it to the operator). Universal facts belong in What to bring or Good to know (block 7).

Block 5 · Payment (branches on `paymentModel`)

Payment

[IF paymentModel = operator_link OR on_arrival]

Deposit paid today: {depositAmount} ({depositPct}%) [\$40.00 / €37,00]

[IF paymentModel = operator_link] Balance due: {balanceAmount} [\$160.00 / €148,00]

[IF paymentModel = on_arrival] Balance due on arrival: {balanceAmount} [\$160.00 / €148,00]

Total: {totalAmount} [\$200.00 / €185,00]

[IF paymentModel = paid_in_full]

Paid in full: {totalAmount}

[IF paymentModel = operator_full]

Total: {totalAmount}, payable to Zipline. Island Tours took no payment.

[IF paymentModel = operator_link] Pay your balance, or cancel for a full refund, up to {cancelDeadlineDateTime} (Curaçao time). After that the deposit is non-refundable, and an unpaid balance cancels the booking.

[IF paymentModel = on_arrival] Cancel for a full refund up to {cancelDeadlineDateTime} (Curaçao time). After that the deposit is non-refundable.

[IF paymentModel = paid_in_full] Cancel for a full refund up to {cancelDeadlineDateTime} (Curaçao time). After that it is non-refundable.

[IF paymentModel = operator_full] (no Island Tours cancel line here; cancellation runs through Zipline, see block 9)

Note: the detailed refund mechanics (Island Tours refunds the deposit, the operator refunds any balance it collected) live in the refund policy, not this email. The email keeps the full-refund-within-the-window headline.

Block 6 • How to pay the rest (branches on `paymentModel`)

[IF `paymentModel = operator_link`] C2 foreshadow (orange box) plus anti-fraud note:

How to pay the rest

{operatorName} will email you a secure link to pay the remaining {balanceAmount}. This is the only payment left on your booking, so look out for that email and pay before the deadline above.

[standalone note with a guard/shield icon, directly below the orange box, neutral gray; "WhatsApp" is a link to the chat] We'll never ask you to send card details by reply, message, or phone. If you're ever unsure about a payment request, check with us on WhatsApp first.

[IF `paymentModel = on_arrival`] Pay the rest on arrival (orange box) plus anti-fraud note:

Pay the rest on arrival

[IF `onArrivalPayment = card_or_cash`] You'll pay the remaining {balanceAmount} to {operatorName} when you arrive. Card and cash are both accepted.

[IF `onArrivalPayment = cash_only`] You'll pay the remaining {balanceAmount} to {operatorName} in cash when you arrive. Card isn't possible and there's no ATM on site, so bring the {balanceAmount} in cash with you.

[standalone note with a guard/shield icon, directly below the orange box, neutral gray] You only pay the rest on arrival. We'll never send a link to pay the balance.

[IF `paymentModel = paid_in_full`] Operator confirmation foreshadow (orange box) plus anti-fraud note:

From {operatorName}

{operatorName} will also email you with their own confirmation and arrival details. Look out for it.

[standalone note with a guard/shield icon, directly below the orange box, neutral gray] Your tour is fully paid. No one should ask you for further payment.

[IF `paymentModel = operator_full`] Operator full-payment foreshadow (orange box) plus anti-fraud note:

Pay to confirm your spot

{operatorName} will email you a secure link to pay the full {totalAmount}. Paying confirms your spot, so look out for that email.

[standalone note with a guard/shield icon, directly below the orange box, neutral gray; "WhatsApp" is a link to the chat] We'll never ask you to send card details by reply, message, or phone. If you're ever unsure about a payment request, check with us on WhatsApp first.

Block 7 • Prepare (conditional)

[IF `whatToBring`] ### What to bring

{whatToBring as bullet list} [/IF]
[IF knowBeforeYouGo] ### Good to know
{knowBeforeYouGo as bullet list, kept short} [/IF]

Editorial routing (CMS): "Bring cash, cards not possible on Klein Curaçao" goes in What to bring. Both What to bring and Good to know are fed from (tour.what_to_bring) and (tour.know_before_you_go), so they only render for tours that have them.

Block 8 • Questions

Questions about the day?

{operatorName} runs your tour and knows it best. Call Email {operatorPhone} · {operatorEmail}

Questions about your booking?

We'll sort it out. Chat on WhatsApp Mon to Sun, 8:00 to 20:00 Curaçao time

Block 9 • Need to cancel (branches on (paymentModel))

[IF paymentModel = operator_full]

Need to cancel?

Zipline handles payment for this tour, so cancellation and refunds run through them under their terms. To cancel, contact Zipline directly. We're on WhatsApp if you have questions.

[ELSE]

Need to cancel?

You can cancel for a full refund up to {cancelDeadlineDateTime} (Curaçao time). Cancel booking [/IF] Your booking details, history, and invoice are always in your Island Tours account at {accountUrl}.

Note: the cancel link opens a cancellation request form (modal), not an instant cancel.

Cancel flow (dev note, v1). The cancel button is a tokenized link that opens a cancellation request form (the modal below) on the booking page. It is not an action: opening the link never cancels anything, so scanner GET prefetch (Microsoft Defender, antivirus, preview panes) cannot trigger a phantom cancellation. The token binds the form to the booking so the traveler does not re-identify it; expiry is the cancellation window (can be weeks), not the 5 to 15 minute magic-link norm.

- Submitting the form sends a cancellation request, with any optional note, to the Island Tours admin, and immediately shows the traveler an on-screen acknowledgment (request received, we will email once it is confirmed). This matters because the action is manual: without it the traveler submits and hears nothing until the admin acts. Prefer the request to also surface as a pending-cancellation item on the booking-management screen, not only as an email, so a missed email cannot leave a request unactioned.
- The cancellation is final only when the Island Tours admin manually marks the booking cancelled on the booking-management screen. At that point both the customer and the tour operator are notified by email. The customer's email uses the locked §6.2 cancellation confirmation copy (refund split and timing), not a generic system notice. The operator's

email tells them the slot is freed and to handle any balance they collected. The admin performed the action, so no separate admin email is needed beyond the system record.

- The deadline is judged on the request timestamp, not when the admin gets to it. A request sent one minute before {cancelDeadlineDateTime} is honored as on time even if processed the next morning.
- The cancellation adjustment to Google Ads and Meta fires when the booking is marked cancelled (tracking dev spec section 18).
- Within the window the refund is full ("no questions asked"). Past the deadline the booking page should reflect the locked, non-refundable state or hide the cancel action; do not show "full refund" past the deadline.
- Account login (v1): email plus booking reference. The reference therefore doubles as a credential, so it must be random and unguessable (not sequential like IT-2026-04821), and login must be rate-limited, because the account holds invoices and PII. Lost-email recovery is via WhatsApp (block 8), since the reference lives only in the email; block 9 points to the account as a positive pointer for the normal case, not as lost-email recovery. Preferred upgrade when revisited: passwordless email login (magic link); if it lands, the lost-email path can point to the account.
- Ethical retention: both actions are clearly available, the framing is neutral, and the note is genuinely optional. No dark patterns: no hidden confirm, no fake scarcity, no guilt. A confirm step lowers the cancel rate only by removing accidental and impulse cancels.
- Later enhancement: automated self-service cancellation (idempotent POST that executes the cancel, instant refund, adjustment fired programmatically) once volume justifies it.

Cancel confirmation modal (booking page, see wireframe mock).

- Title: Are you sure you want to cancel?
- Booking line (neutral, confirms what is being cancelled): {tourName} · {dateShort}
- Subtext: Full refund, no questions asked. We'll email you to confirm.
- Optional note field. Placeholder: Optional. Anything you'd like us to know?
- Primary: Yes, cancel booking. Secondary: Keep my booking.

Block 10 • Sign-off

Island Tours. Built by Islanders. www.island.tours ITG B.V. (Island Tours Group) · KvK Curaçao 169950 Caracasbaaiweg 366, Willemstad, Curaçao This is a transactional booking email.

Block 11 • More {islandName} experiences (upsell, bottom-anchored)

More {islandName} experiences

[relatedTours: 2 cards, each using the tour featured image at a landscape card crop (not the square block 2 thumbnail), title, rating, price, link] [Browse all {islandName} tours](#)

Note: this block sits below the sign-off and never above the C2 foreshadow. It is content only. Do not add marketing headers (List-Unsubscribe) or a social-icon row to this transactional email, so the transactional reputation stays clean. {islandName} is the island of the booked

tour (Curaçao at launch); `allToursUrl` points to that island's catalog. Card images use the same featured-image source as block 2 but a landscape crop sized for the card frame, served at display dimensions with alt = tour name.

9. Open items to resolve

- Tour-day check-in. Does the traveler show this email or the reference, or does the operator work from a name list? If proof is needed, add a conditional "Show this email to your guide" line and consider a lightweight voucher.
- Operator payment email architecture. Does Island Tours send it on behalf of the operator (operator-attributed, IT controls the template and deliverability), or does the operator's own system send it? This decides whether IT can protect that email's deliverability, which directly affects the C2 mitigation.
- Add-ons and extras itemization. Some tours carry paid extras (transfer, dives, premium bar) plus a free-text comment. The email does not itemize them yet. Resolve before building: which extras are prepaid (inside total and deposit) versus paid on site, and whether to show a selected-extras list above deposit, balance, and total. Render only selected extras, never empty fields.
- Deadline window verification. Confirm the actual pay-and-cancel window per tour with the operator so the email matches what they honor.
- React Email vs MJML for the build. Resend favors React Email. Confirm with Arnav.
- Sync the final block 6 anti-fraud line back to Design_Brief_BookingWidget.md §6.2.
- Fix the em-dash in the Brand Voice Bible's stored confirmation subject line to match the no-em-dash rule.